

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp *****

MONDAY, JANUARY 6, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXV NO. 4

WSJ.com

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Last week: DJIA 42732.13 ▼ 260.08 0.60% NASDAQ 19621.68 ▼ 0.5% STOXX 600 508.19 ▲ 0.2% 10-YR. TREASURY ▲ 6/32, yield 4.596% OIL \$73.96 ▲ \$3.36 EURO \$1.0309 YEN 157.30

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Investigators found** several Nazi-linked accounts originally discovered by Credit Suisse that the bank never disclosed to a 1990s review of its wartime activities. **A1**

◆ **Centerview's status** as one of the few boutique banks that hasn't gone public or taken outside money might change, co-founder Blair Efron hinted, suggesting the firm was becoming more open to exploring options. **B1**

◆ **The nation's busiest** spaceports are fielding record demand, heralding a potential traffic jam that is spurring new efforts to develop launch sites in landlocked states and even at sea. **B1**

◆ **Amazon.com's** Prime Video streaming service licensed what it said was a documentary about former and future first lady Melania Trump that is expected to be released in the second half. **B3**

◆ **Booz Allen agreed to** a \$15.9 million settlement with the Justice Department, resolving allegations the company submitted fraudulent claims to the U.S. under military task orders. **B3**

◆ **Biden overrode** top national-security aides when he decided to quash a Japanese takeover of U.S. Steel and instead align with his domestic advisers to bolster his pro-union legacy. **A2**

◆ **Mines in the developing** world are caught up in tensions over profits, and host countries are increasingly using force or the threat of it to get a bigger share. **B1**

World-Wide

◆ **Iran entered 2025** with a weak hand to confront the incoming Trump administration after experiencing an acute economic crisis at home and unprecedented setbacks in the Middle East. **A1**

◆ **The U.S. Army veteran** who rammed a pickup truck into a crowd in New Orleans twice visited the city in the months leading up to the attack and on one trip recorded video of the area. **A4**

◆ **Republicans are** wrestling over how quickly they can deliver Trump some legislative wins, with House and Senate leaders divided over the speed and scope of action early in his term. **A4**

◆ **Biden named 19** recipients of the Presidential Medal of Freedom, including Hillary Clinton, Earvin 'Magic' Johnson and the late civil-rights pioneer Fannie Lou Hamer. **A3**

◆ **The Biden administration** notified Congress of an \$8 billion weapons package for Israel, one of the largest new arms sales since the war in Gaza began in 2023. **A6**

◆ **Plans to ease** restrictions on humanitarian aid for Syria will be announced by the Biden administration, a move to speed delivery of basic supplies without lifting sanctions on other assistance to Damascus. **A6**

◆ **New York state's new toll** for drivers entering the center of Manhattan took effect, meaning that many people will pay \$9 for access to the busiest part of the city during peak hours. **A2**

JOURNAL REPORT
Investing Monthly: How to navigate markets this year. **B5-6**

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Big Chill Hits as Storm Sweeps Across the U.S.



JEFF ROBERSON/ASSOCIATED PRESS

HOWLING: A powerful winter storm Sunday unleashed heavy snow, ice and frigid temperatures across a large part of the U.S., including St. Louis, above, snarling travel with a wave of flight cancellations and making roads hazardous. **A3**

China's New Hacking Prowess Poses Geopolitical Threats

The message from President Biden's national security adviser was startling.

Chinese hackers had gained the ability to shut down dozens of U.S. ports, power grids and

miliar with it. The attack could threaten lives, and the government needed the companies' help to root out the intruders.

What no one at the briefing knew, including Sullivan: China's hackers were already working their way deep inside U.S. telecom networks, too.

The two massive hacking operations have upended the West's understanding of what Beijing wants, while revealing the astonishing skill level and stealth of its keyboard warriors—once seen as the cyber equivalent of clumsy burglars.

China's hackers were previ-

ously thought to be interested chiefly in business secrets and private consumer data. But the latest hacks make clear they are now soldiers on the front lines of potential geopolitical conflict between the U.S. and China, in which cyberwarfare tools are expected to be powerful weapons.

U.S. computer networks are a "key battlefield in any future conflict" with China, said Brandon Wales, a former top U.S. cybersecurity official at the Department of Homeland Security, who closely tracked China's hacking operations against American infrastruc-

ture. He said the operations "are designed to ensure they prevail by keeping the U.S. from projecting power, and inducing chaos at home."

As China increasingly threatens Taiwan, working toward what Western intelligence officials see as a target of being ready to invade by 2027, the U.S. could be pulled into the fray as the island's most important backer. Other friction between Washington and Beijing has intensified in recent years, with President-elect Donald Trump threaten-

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A Weaker Iran Looks To Tackle Trump 2.0

By **Benoit Faucon**

Iran faces a tough year of confrontation with the incoming Trump administration while holding a weak hand after 2024 left it with an acute economic crisis at home and setbacks in the Middle East.

The new U.S. administration plans to increase sanctions on Iran as part of an effort to contain its support for militant groups in the Middle East. Tehran's strategy, less potent than it was, still threatens Washington's allies and partners, especially Israel, and is also unpopular among many ordinary Iranians. President-elect Donald Trump's team is also weighing options, including

airstrikes, to keep Iran from building a nuclear weapon.

Iran's economy has already been crippled by bad management, corruption and sanctions. Power shortages disrupt offices, schools and manufacturing plants. Iran's military threat has been blunted by Israel's battering of allies Hezbollah in Lebanon, Hamas in Gaza, the now-collapsed Assad regime in Syria and much of Iran's air defenses.

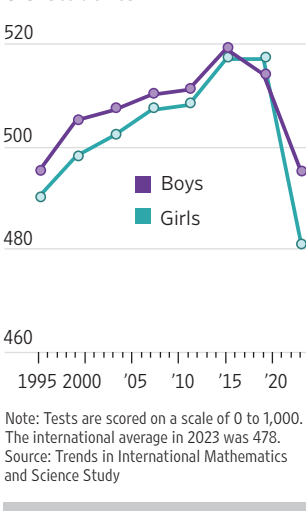
The Islamic Republic's difficulties represent the biggest challenge to its clerical leaders since 2022, when the death of a young woman in police custody after allegedly wearing an improper veil

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Tests Show Girls Lagging

A WSJ analysis of test scores found girls losing ground in reading, math and science. **A3**

Eighth-grade math scores, U.S. students



Uber, Lyft Gear Up For the Revolution In Driverless Taxis

By **Preetika Rana**

Uber Technologies and Lyft gave up on big plans to develop their own driverless taxis years ago. Now, they are revamping their businesses to accommodate competitors that might have figured it out.

The ride-hailing leaders are preparing to bring driverless taxis to your door with new app features that allow customers to use their phones to open trunks and honk horns. They are building infrastructure to maintain the high-tech taxis and training human sup-

port staff to handle riders without drivers.

Both companies will have driverless cars—from Alphabet's Waymo and others—on their apps this year. In the coming months, riders in Atlanta and Austin, Texas, will be able to hail a Waymo through the Uber app. Lyft plans to offer May Mobility's driverless taxis in Atlanta.

Uber and Lyft have agreed to maintain these driverless fleets. They are finding locations to store the cars, equipping them with chargers and

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They Just Want to Have Cheap Tickets

* * *

Concert fans wait out bargains; \$9 to see Cyndi Lauper

By **Chris Kornelis** and **Anne Steele**

Casey McNerthney has never been a Cyndi Lauper buff. For most of his life, he'd change the radio channel when he heard "Girls Just Want to Have Fun." But he is a huge fan of landing concert tickets for cheap—especially for shows in big arenas, stadiums and amphitheaters, where he gets to experience an artist (and throngs of their devotees) for the first time.

So in December, when he noticed \$9 tickets—including fees—to the Seattle stop of Lauper's farewell tour hours

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This Man Dreamed Big: A Perfect Credit Score

By **Imani Moise**

Steve Michell had one of the best credit scores in the U.S. But he wanted a perfect 850.

So the 52-year-old Texan started tinkering with his 840s score. He followed tips on his banking app, then came to believe they were bunk. He closed credit cards, tweaked balances and adjusted when he paid his bills. He would make a change, then wait a month to see how his score rose or fell. He adjusted again. He waited again.

"I'm an engineer by trade, so everything has to be perfect," he said.

Michell spent five years trying to crack the formula on his credit score. In doing so, he put an exclamation point on the U.S.'s growing obsession with the three-digit grade of financial health.

Like many, Michell felt that the ups and downs in his

score defied explanation. Yes, paying bills on time helps and maxing out cards hurts. But financially responsible moves such as closing old accounts can ding your score, while opening more credit cards can boost it. Credit histories vary so much that what helps one person might not help another.

Credit scores are also playing a more influential role in our lives right now. No longer just a tool to help lenders decide whether to approve loans and how much to charge, credit scores are now an all-purpose ranking system. They are used to decide whether you can rent a home, what your insurance premiums should be and even if you can get a date.

Credit bureaus like Equifax, Experian and TransUnion, and scoring companies like FICO and VantageScore

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